

1. How would you describe Walmart's strategy ?

Walmart's key strategies are low price and great values, store-wide efficiency, global expansion by controlling multiple companies, environmental sustainability and adaptation to changing market segments. I consider these strategies pivotal elements for maintaining a top-tier position in the industry. The sentiments of Walmart's CEO, the emphasis on perpetual transformation and staying ahead of competitors, not merely to triumph but effective anticipation to meet future customer demands. As a student, I appreciate the strategy of low price and best value. Oftentimes before I purchase something I always compare the prices and quality. I always find myself buying the Walmart product which is a win-win deal for both Walmart and me as a consumer. I believe, "low cost and great value" is a core part of their strategy and a key reason for their success. The overarching **efficiency** across the entire store is a feature I perceive as inherently customer-centric. This strategic emphasis holds particular significance for retailers, exemplified by industry leader Walmart, specializing in the provision of everyday essential goods. Despite catering to a substantial customer base of 37 million individuals daily, Walmart's commitment to efficiency ensures that the shopping experience remains streamlined and unhindered. Furthermore, diversifying through global expansion entails more than just Walmart itself. By acquiring and overseeing companies such as Vudu, Asada, and the Seiyu Group, strategically positioned across Asia, Europe, and Canada, Walmart gains a distinct competitive edge. This approach not only broadens the company's reach but also provides access to a diverse array of resources on a global scale. Moreover, environmental sustainability has emerged as a critical concern, particularly in the context of the recent generation. This strategic focus not only conveys a clear message to the upcoming generations, including Gen Z and beyond, but also underscores the idea that each Walmart purchase contributes positively to the environment. This commitment to sustainability serves as a pivotal element in upholding the company's esteemed reputation. Finally, the visionary approach towards adapting to evolving market segments resonates deeply with me. I agree with the sentiments expressed by the CEO in the passage. Acknowledging the perpetual evolution of everything around us, meeting the future market demands poses a formidable challenge. While securing a prominent position in the industry could have initially been attributed to a groundbreaking idea or a stroke of luck, sustaining that top-tier status over time demands unwavering commitment, dedication, and foresight. Walmart's enduring position as a leader for years stands as compelling evidence of their visionary approach. I firmly believe that by consistently adhering to these strategic principles, Walmart has the potential to establish itself as a lasting legacy in the industry.

2. What does Walmart do (operations & other) to fulfill their strategy?

Walmart is a company with multiple strategies, and it puts efforts into various fields to fulfill them. Walmart's headquarters are located in Bentonville, Arkansas, and it boasts a global workforce of over 2.3 million people. As of January 2022, Walmart had an annual revenue of

\$573 billion USD, which is derived from diverse sources. Walmart controls several companies such as Vudu, Moosejaw, and Art.com, among others. I find this strategy to be truly remarkable in its execution, offering a compelling pathway to achieve global expansion and assert dominance over competitors.

Doug McMillon, Walmart's current CEO, is overseeing the company's strategy and transformation into an innovation-focused entity. McMillon recognizes the role of current and emerging technologies in enhancing customer service. Walmart's innovation initiatives include piloting an open delivery platform, testing Jetblack voice and text-based commerce, and exploring automation in various operational aspects. These initiatives show that Walmart is adapting to the changes and getting prepared for the future. I firmly believe in the power of technology, and I think businesses should gradually begin utilizing and investing in it as the tide turns. Since Walmart is investigating AI, they have a competitive advantage.

I believe that Walmart aims to maintain its core competency in buying and selling merchandise, utilizing data analytics and automation software to elevate service quality. Walmart is also using data utilization for tailored product offerings, agricultural research for sustainable food products, and the implementation of software automation bots to enhance efficiency in traditional human resource processes. H. Lee Scott, a former Walmart CEO, emphasized the necessity for massive change and continuous self-challenge to stay ahead in a rapidly changing world. I believe that Walmart has the potential to take a leadership role in the retail industry, including ethical and environmentally friendly sourcing, reducing dependence on high-carbon energy sources, providing greater value to customers for everyday needs, and fostering diversity and inclusivity within the company. The next generation is focusing on topics like sustainability, technology and these efforts of Walmart from the CEO itself reinforces GenZ's like me and many others. It is not just targeting the upcoming future but it deeply resonates with my values as well. Walmart remains dedicated to transforming and succeeding in the face of global and strategic complexities.

3. Given the 7 conditions of when an alliance becomes "strategic" (e.g., via M&A), how well does Walmart do on p. 170? Thoughts?

I believe that Walmart has effectively diversified its business through strategic acquisitions, such as Flipkart and Jet.com, demonstrating their commitment to expanding their presence globally across various sectors. I am positive that Walmart's global presence, with ownership stakes in companies across different countries, aligns with their strategic approach to expanding alliances internationally. For example: I was aware of the company called FlipKart from India, and it was a huge surprise to me that it was a part of Walmart. FlipKart is very popular in India, which is used by many youths. Being able to target such a huge market of India and also be dominant in it is strategic. Other than that, Walmart is also investing in technological

innovation, focusing on data analytics, automation, and emerging technologies to gain a competitive advantage. This proves that Walmart is constantly trying to stay ahead through multiple ways.

Walmart has an opportunity to be a leader in ethical and environmentally friendly sourcing, aligning with their strategic considerations related to corporate responsibility and sustainability. I'm confident that Walmart's acknowledgement of challenges and commitment to continuous improvement and transformation aligns with their strategic condition of recognizing and addressing difficulties.